

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 45

UTAH
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Utah's family courts and child-welfare system.

68

UTAH FAMILIES ON RECORD · 132
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 6 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 5, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
21 OF 29

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · UTAH

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Utah. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Catherine Conklin

JUDGE · WEBER · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Same person... so the same reason. Kept delaying hearings to give abuser more chance for custody of kids."* WEBER COUNTY

> *"Imputed at full time wages, affecting ability to obtain financial aid and live."* WEBER COUNTY

> *"Ignored domestic violence protections in favor of abusive parent."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ut-catherine-conklin/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Kyle Hancock

CUSTODY EVALUATOR · CACHE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He lied in one of his letters to the court by stating his job is to evaluate both homes with my child. That never happened. He then stated in a hearing that he only evaluated one home as that was all he needed to do. Evaluator only evaluated my son with the petitioner's family at their home but never evaluated my son at our home with his only sibling. He questioned my son so the Petitioners home about the abuse they did while they were present. He thinks it's a good idea to question a child victim in a comfortable setting. How can it be a comfortable setting when the child is being questioned in the very place the abuse occurred?"*

> *"Dr. Kyle Hancock completely abandoned his role as an objective psychologist and court investigator to act as a private advocate for a parent who has engaged in documented written perjury, severe medical neglect, asset spoliation, financial fraud, and systemic parental alienation."* DAVIS COUNTY

> *"Has never presented the crimes of which my abuser has committed. My son continues to be injured but the custody evaluator and GAL are very inter related."* BOX ELDER

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ut-kyle-hancock/complaint-packet
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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

UTAH AT A GLANCE.

Across 68 Utah families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
132
67 of 68 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$145,600
median across 42 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
6
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
52.9%
36 of 68 who answered; 33 of 68 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
68	2.0	67 of 68	21

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Utah families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF UTAH FAMILY COURT

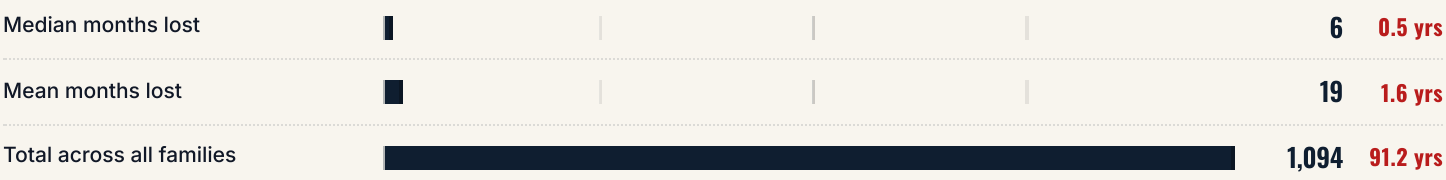
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	49	$20,700	$88,545	$4,338,699
Lost Wages	44	$24,500	$74,848	$3,293,325
Other Court Fees	23	$2,980	$7,139	$164,205
Therapy / Evaluations	31	$2,500	$5,816	$180,309
Reunification Services	12	$1,125	$4,274	$51,284
GAL Fees	26	$2,750	$6,369	$165,600
Asset Loss [1]	36	$56,500	—	—
Median Family Burden (42 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$145,600	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($56,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · UTAH

Most families documenting in Utah are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	41	61%
Case closed: within last 2 years	13	19%
Active case: progress being made	5	7%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	4	6%
Not provided	4	6%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	35	51%
Family Court Only	25	37%
CPS Only	5	7%
Unknown	2	3%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)	1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	19	28%
3 – 5 years	17	25%
5 – 10 years	15	22%
Less than 6 months	7	10%
6 months – 1 year	7	10%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	22	32%
50/50 Joint	18	26%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	11	16%
Full Custody	9	13%
Children in Foster Care	5	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Salt Lake	14	25%
Weber	9	16%
Davis	7	12%
Utah	4	7%
Duchesne	3	5%
Sevier	2	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	25	37%
High Conflict Divorce	16	24%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	13	19%
Other	5	7%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	2	3%

05 PARENT VOICES — UTAH

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Utah comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *CPS took my kids for 10 months because they spoke up about abuse the other parent was doing. They said I coached my kids even though I had hospital records and PO from another judge still fighting for sole custody especially because my ex wanted our children to stay in foster [...]*
>
> — HALEY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Access to children only to abuser(my ex husband) denied regular updates and photos as entitled to after termination of rights

— UTAH PARENT · CHERYL

MORE VOICES FROM UTAH

The system has stolen my kids and allowed legal kidnapping to occur

— STEVEN

They have stripped all forms of safety from my child and myself. I went through domestic violence, it's not physical anymore, but all other forms. I trust no one. You must be an abuser of elderly, women, and children to be protected by the court. I would be heard and listened [...]

— MELONIE

Complete psychological terrorism. My adult daughters testified in court against my ex (who also abused them), the judge gas lit them, discredited their testimonies. After his corrupt ruling, they both said to me "I'm never having kids". Destroyed their future and hopes for [...]

— LIZ

Broken systems have allowed my children to be entangled in abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Document and record everything. I have cameras in my home now to protect myself and my children from false accusations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Absolutely destroyed our family dynamic and the deep bond our children had shared with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Wedge between me and my kids, false accusations. Long term mediation resulting in supervised visitations. Paid.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have emotional, psychologically and caused so much sadness, insecurity, irreparable damages to my children. The judge ignored the abuse allegations And neglect caused to my son by the non-familial family despite the evidence I provided.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has kept me and my children in a prolonged, high-conflict process where repeated litigation, delays, and enforcement gaps have allowed instability to continue instead of creating lasting protection and consistency in which it's supposed to be intended [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

He broke the system to protect the abuser, forcing me into a legal minefield where my child's physical and biological safety is traded for an abuser's convenience, turning a system meant to protect a toddler into the very mechanism that endangers his life

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed it from head to toe. The death of my father to my child's brain injury.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Utter destruction. Literally having to climb out of an abyss and start building from the ground up.

— LAURIE

They have created trauma that never needed to happen. Then gave them to the people creating the trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Incentivizes DIVORCE and the breakup of families, RAPES mostly good men/fathers of being fathers to their children and of money/income to take care of their kids and themselves for the rest of their lives. Places their kids in HIGH RISK categories of crime, depression, suicide [...]

— CHRIS

Utah Courts are known as the judicial industrial complex. It's a farce and creates acrimony and billable hours. Judges hands are not clean.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *My ex has admitted to domestic violence in his court documents, he has been high on drugs around kids and court looking to give him 50/50 through a GAL, while making me pay for psych evals. GAL came out in favor for dad without even talking to me.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Let the one who hates the most, has the most money, and uses our children, be rewarded with the privilege of raising our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has tore our family apart. Some of the saddest most painful moments I have ever been through.

— JIM

This system abused my babies and I for financial gain. Lied and abused power because I tried to stand up, we did nothing wrong and was still punched.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ruined my life, lost my employment, can't see my grandchildren. I have been emotionally and financially ruined. I have been incarcerated for acts I did not do. I have had to sell my beautiful home that I and my disabled sister bought so the children had a home.

— JA NAE

Court ordered that my two boys go live with their unemployed father who has a Protective Order (and has been arrested) after he coached them to tell a therapist I was abusive. Even the therapist said the children's stories didn't make sense, but she had to report regardless.

— ELIZABETH

They have destroyed me and my daughters life. I don't know what to do or how I can fix any of this. I am up against monsters that don't play by the rules.

— IVY

It's causing severe mental and emotional harm to my children and extreme burden on me personally and financially trying to maintain my job and self represent

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have stolen the voice of an innocent child who has only shown bravery to stand up to his abuser. He has lost hope for not being abused and knows that what is going on is wrong. Anyone touching his penis, butt or forcing him to touch anyone else's is child sex abuse. The [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Working on childs case takes away from sibling.. spent college fund on it ect*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids are still at risk and I have to come up with more money to make sure he cant have custody as he is a abusive, addict with mental issues. If something were to happen to me they would have to go with him and he will ruin them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed a safety net to be manipulated and turned into a weapon- the emergency ex-parte TRO. The system allowed my abuser to continue his abuse post-separation by exploiting legal measures meant to protect victims. Even when truth comes to light and the cases are [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

At a time when our family needed one another the most, they separated us. The results, the outcome, the irresponsibility, unfathomable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Haven't held my boys sing may 8 th 3021. Haven't had one moment of connection. Now we are strangers. Now they are weapons to hurt me and nothing more. They are now motherless and I am alone

— KACIE

It's too painful to type in one box. Ive been put through three custody evaluations so far. Looking at a fourth. Has gone on for 15 years in two states with two different exes teaming up to lie for each other to get out of child support

— ANGELA

Without taking the statement, the police took my son into custody on false allegations that were dropped 6 weeks later. In the meantime of protective order at a caution was put on him so he couldn't see his daughter. Right before all charges were dropped, she put a civil suit [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This high-conflict divorce has taken nearly every part of my life that mattered most to me. I lost my home, I lost substantial time with my children, and I have watched my relationship with them become strained while feeling powerless to protect it. I have experienced what feels [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has shown my kid that, despite all the evidence, I am a bad person and can't be trusted all while separating a loving relationship and an entire family of love.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

So far... it has NOT helped. I'm 13 months in, rn. Pro se divorcing my 22yr husband who I found had a completely "other" lifestyle he was engaging in... ?! (If you're in UT, you know the sexual deviancy and predation I speak of...)

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

DCFS lied and stole my daughter 6 years old even though I was doing everything asked of me. I lost my job, entire family exiled me, my will to live is almost gone.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex husband has taken everything he threatened to with the exception of the lives of the children and I. I am terrified to fight back because I recognize all prior threats made were followed through on. I have to choose between staying silent or risking him ending our lives. [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has repeatedly prioritized procedural disputes and allegations over documented concerns about my child's safety, forcing me into ongoing legal battles while I continue to follow professional guidance and report disclosures appropriately. As a result, my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Reprimanded me for kissing my newborn after 4 hours of un-medicated labor, threatened with jail time due to false allegations alienation, callously told me to "just pump" rather than being able to breastfeed my infant, lost full custody due to false allegations of alienation [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

41 Utah parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — UTAH

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Utah families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> CPS took my kids for 10 months because they spoke up about abuse the other parent was doing. They said I coached my kids even though I had hospital records and PO from another judge still fighting for sole custody especially because my ex wanted our children to stay in foster care.
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> — STEVEN

> They have stripped all forms of safety from my child and myself. I went through domestic violence, it's not physical anymore, but all other forms. I trust no one. You must be an abuser of elderly, women, and children to be protected by the court. I would be heard and listened too in a criminal case more. The family system is not family focused and they support generational trauma. The moms can't work, but have to sole provide with no child support. The judges exact words to me, "you are definitely not safe around him (my ex) but your child is". What??? My child is in survival mode with his so called father. He has stomach issues and anxiety and teachers make comments of his confidence. And the court thinks that is not abuse? I hate the family court, they clearly are ignorant. Trained to spot abusers, not victims, they have zero clue of DARVO. It's shockingly embarrassing and very scary.
>
> — MELONIE

> Complete psychological terrorism. My adult daughters testified in court against my ex (who also abused them), the judge gas lit them, discredited their testimonies. After his corrupt ruling, they both said to me "I'm never having kids". Destroyed their future and hopes for healthy families, etc. Allowed my two little ones to be abused repeatedly and their father given full protection and immunity from investigation and accountability.
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The family court system has kept me and my children in a prolonged, high-conflict process where repeated litigation, delays, and enforcement gaps have allowed instability to continue instead of creating lasting protection and consistency in which it's supposed to be intended for. So far it has given an abuser temporary custody, now he's trying to take it again for false reasons, with the gal on his side. It has forced me to parent under constant scrutiny and emotional strain while my children remain exposed to financial strain uncertainty, conflict their father won't stop, and avoidable disruption to their wellbeing due to him being allowed to bring me to court every year.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This high-conflict divorce has taken nearly every part of my life that mattered most to me. I lost my home, I lost substantial time with my children, and I have watched my relationship with them become strained while feeling powerless to protect it. I have experienced what feels like being portrayed negatively to my children and have seen signs that they do not feel comfortable expressing views that differ from their mother's. Throughout the court process, I felt that my concerns, testimony, and efforts as a father were discounted rather than seriously considered. The result has left me feeling not only financially and emotionally devastated, but also heartbroken by the loss of meaningful time, trust, and connection with my children.

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My ex husband has taken everything he threatened to with the exception of the lives of the children and I. I am terrified to fight back because I recognize all prior threats made were followed through on. I have to choose between staying silent or risking him ending our lives. It's no place for any parent or child to exist in.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has repeatedly prioritized procedural disputes and allegations over documented concerns about my child's safety, forcing me into ongoing legal battles while I continue to follow professional guidance and report disclosures appropriately. As a result, my family has experienced emotional, financial, and psychological strain while I work to protect my child and maintain stability in the face of repeated motions, accusations, and delayed responses to evidence.

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Reprimanded me for kissing my newborn after 4 hours of un-medicated labor, threatened with jail time due to false allegations alienation, callously told me to "just pump" rather than being able to breastfeed my infant, lost full custody due to false allegations of alienation, lost medical authority due false allegations of non-compliance in with medical records.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I feel like Hancock's strategy has been to keep the conflict alive at every opportunity, forcing me to spend thousands of dollars and countless hours responding to things that never should have been issues in the first place. It's been emotionally and financially draining, and it feels like resolution has taken a back seat to prolonging the fight.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

41 full approved Utah comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Utah report comes from Utah respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Utah — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 68 Utah families reporting here are not the universe of Utah families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

STANDWITHMEG.COM | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.